

This time, MAGA base quieter on Iran attack

Voices against drawn-out conflict are more muted than they were in June

BY NATALIE ALLISON AND MICHAEL BIRNBAUM

Three days before President Donald Trump authorized strikes against Iran last June, the prominent conservative activist Charlie Kirk sat in the Oval Office and expressed his concerns about the United States becoming involved in another drawn-out conflict in the Middle East.

Kirk, an influential pro-Trump leader closely attuned to the president's MAGA base, had spent the preceding weeks issuing public warnings on his podcast and social media channels. Along with other conservative influencers like Stephen K. Bannon and Tucker Carlson, Kirk warned against pursuing regime change in Iran and the potential for the U.S. to get pulled into a longer war.

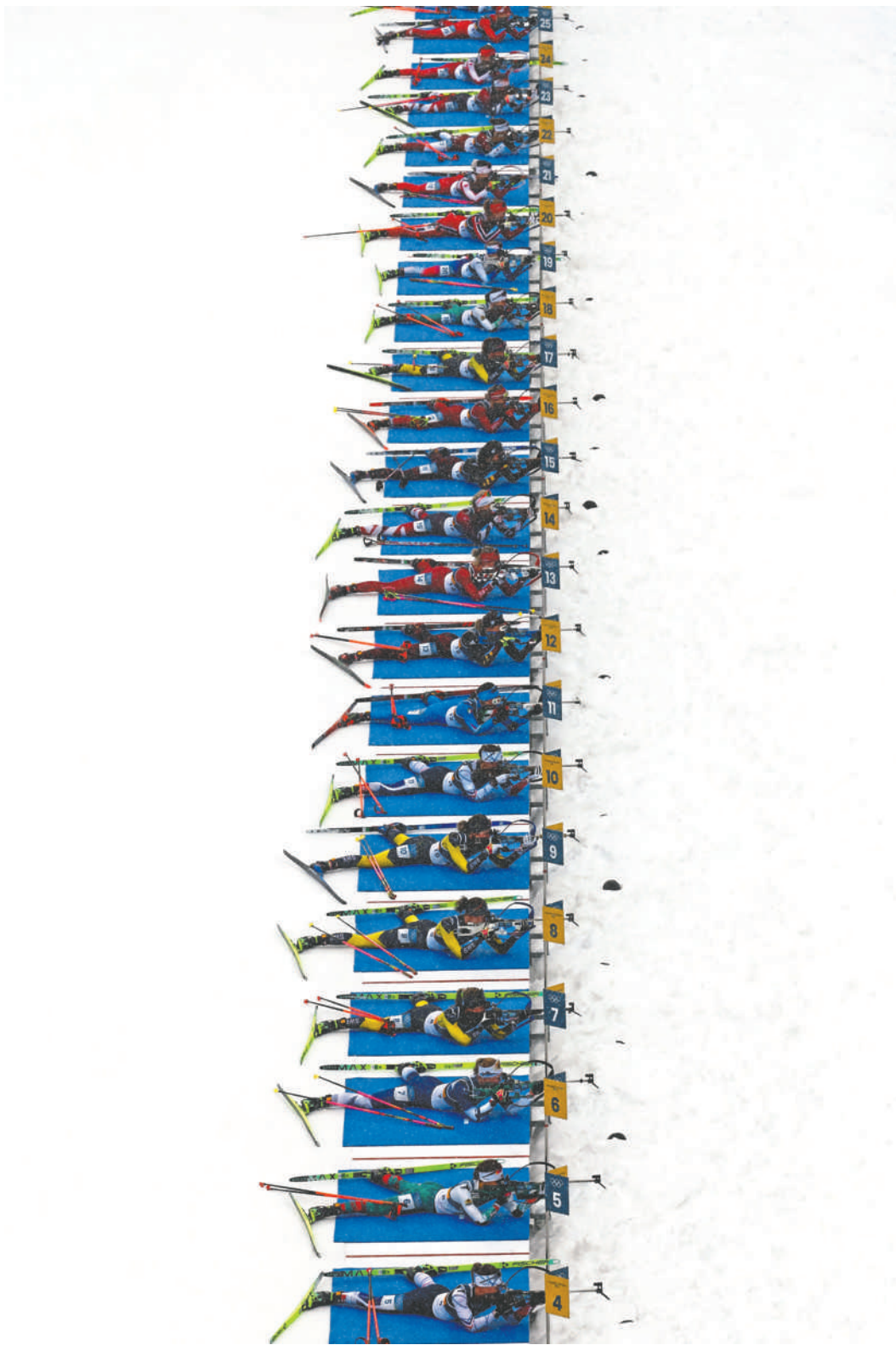
"We must resist the siren song of displacing dictators in lands we do not understand and we have no business running," Kirk said on his show on June 13. "I could tell you right now, our MAGA base does not want a war, at all, whatsoever. They do not want U.S. involvement. They do not want the United States to be engaged in this."

But as the president now weighs just that — potentially launching an extended military assault on Iran, and signaling openness to toppling its supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei — the MAGA movement's public and private lobbying against it is much more muted this time.

"America First"-aligned leaders and commentators told The Washington Post this week that the change stems from a combination of factors, including the

SEE IRAN ON A11

Lining up a perfect shot



MATTHEW CHILDS/REUTERS

Athletes are seen in action Saturday in South Tyrol, Italy, at the women's 12.5km mass start, in which 30 competitors ski five laps, shooting in prone twice and standing twice. Team France took home gold and silver. **Olympics coverage, B1**

A new era of tariff tumult as Trump reacts to legal loss

IMPOSES NEW GLOBAL LEVY, THEN RAISES IT

President pledges to work around high court's ruling

BY DAVID J. LYNCH

The blockbuster Supreme Court ruling that invalidated President Donald Trump's emergency tariffs ends one chapter of economic uncertainty and begins another.

Even as the nation's high court determined Friday that the president had exceeded his authority by slapping tariffs on goods from just about every country in the world, Trump made clear at a White House news conference that he was determined to do so again, though this time within the bounds of the law.

Assembling that presidential "Plan B" will take months, meaning the tariff-fueled confusion that has weighed on the economy will linger as the November congressional elections draw nearer.

Trump took the first step Friday by ordering a new 10 percent tariff on all imports under Section 122 of a 1974 trade law,

effective 12:01 a.m. Tuesday. Saturday morning, he raised that levy to 15 percent, announcing the move in a Truth Social post.

The high court action ends more than a year of this sort of presidential freelancing, which saw tariffs imposed on the grounds of economics, national security and personal whim. Thanks to the Supreme Court, Trump no longer can introduce, modify or remove tariffs for any reason simply by tapping out a social media post on his smartphone.

But if that unpredictable quick-draw era has ended, plenty of new questions remain in its wake. Will the government refund the \$134 billion-plus that it

SEE TARIFFS ON A10

The Sunday Take: Congress shares the blame for Trump's overreach. **A2**

Course change?: Until now, court spent year siding with Trump. **A10**

Extra \$500B for military trips Pentagon planners

White House is weeks behind in struggle over where to put the money

BY JEFF STEIN AND DAN LAMOTHE

Trump administration officials have struggled to figure out how to increase U.S. military spending by a whopping \$500 billion in their forthcoming budget, slowing the overall White House spending plan, four people familiar with the matter said.

President Donald Trump last month agreed to a roughly 50 percent funding boost sought by Pete Hegseth, the defense secretary, in the White House's annual budget proposal. The idea ran into internal criticism from several other officials, including White House budget chief Russell Vought, who warned about its potential impact on the widening federal deficit, said the people,

who spoke on the condition of anonymity to reflect internal deliberations.

Since Trump agreed to the higher number, White House aides and defense officials have run into logistical challenges surrounding where to put the money, because the amount is so large, the people said. The White House is more than two weeks behind its statutory deadline to send its budget proposal to Congress, in part because it is unclear how precisely to spend the additional \$500 billion, according to the people familiar with the matter.

Senior Pentagon officials have consulted with former senior defense officials as they grapple with the challenge, said one person familiar with the matter. Part of the discussion centers on how much emphasis should go into buying weapons the military already uses versus investing in high-end technologies, such as artificial intelligence, that the Pentagon envisions as part of its future.

SEE BUDGET ON A11

Fake deportation tip line becomes viral social satire

BY DREW HARWELL

Ben Palmer, a stand-up comic in Nashville, has built a following online with his signature style of elaborate deadpan pranks, stumbling his way onto court TV shows and pyramid-scheme calls to poke fun at the latent absurdities of American life.

Then in January of last year, he

had an idea for a new bit: He'd set up a fake tip line that people could use to report anyone they thought was an undocumented immigrant. It was darker than his other stunts, but it felt topical, the kind of challenge he wanted to try. At the very least, he thought, he might get a few calls he could talk about at his next show.

Instead, his tip line has received nearly 100 submissions from across the country: people reporting their neighbors, ex-lovers, Uber drivers, strangers they saw at the grocery store. One tip came from a teacher reporting the parents of a kindergarten student at her school.

"I mean, they seem like nice people or whatever," the woman

told Palmer on the call. "But if they're taking up resources from our county, I'm not into illegal people being here."

What began as a comedy routine has become one of the most viral pieces of social satire during President Donald Trump's mass-deportation campaign. The kindergarten video has been

SEE HOTLINE ON A9

Nor'easter expected to batter region over the next two days

BY BEN NOLL

A powerful nor'easter will soon slam the Mid-Atlantic and Northeast, in some spots delivering more than a foot of snow as well as blizzard conditions and flooding near the coast on Sunday and Monday.

The conditions will lead to dangerous travel and the potential for road closures, flight and school cancellations, particularly in the stretch from Delaware to Massachusetts. This zone is likely to experience intense snow bands from Sunday night through Monday, pushing snowfall beyond a foot. This heavy, wet snow will weigh on trees and power lines, potentially causing outages — and will be strenuous to clear.

The storm's forecast track has trended closer to the coast, which means nearly 100 million people

Mid-Atlantic, Northeast spots could see blizzard and flooding conditions

in the densely populated stretch from D.C. to Boston can expect moderate-to-extreme winter weather impacts. Some people in this zone are under a blizzard warning — the first in more than four years.

Snow is expected to get underway on Sunday, intensifying later in the day and at night — when conditions will deteriorate across the region — and won't end until Monday night when the storm departs New England.

Here is a detailed forecast for 12 cities that will be affected by the

SEE STORM ON A15

Off-the-grid data centers may pose threat to environment

BY EVAN HALPER

The GW Ranch project approved on 8,000 windswept acres of West Texas will look like many of the other data centers that have sprung up across the country to support Silicon Valley's ambitions for artificial intelligence. Dozens of airplane-hangar-size warehouses packed with computing hardware will consume more power than all of Chicago.

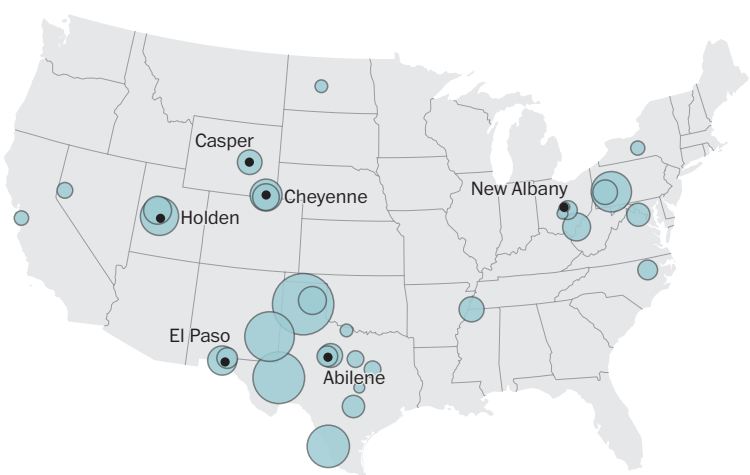
But it's missing one standard feature: The mammoth project, recently green-lit by state environmental regulators, won't need new power lines to deliver the electricity that it guzzles. GW Ranch will be walled off from the power grid and generate its own electricity from natural gas and solar plants installed on site.

GW Ranch is set to become part of a shadow power grid emerging across the country with potentially far-reaching consequences for

Big Tech's shadow power grid

Dozens of data centers with private power plants on-site are planned across the United States.

Capacity in megawatts ○ 1,000 ○ 4,000 ○ 10,000



Source: Cleanview, Washington Post reporting

EVAN HALPER / THE WASHINGTON POST

the U.S. electricity system and environment.

After the rapid growth of data centers triggered pushback from politicians, utilities and local residents over the pressures they place on the grid, tech companies are now building their own fleet of private power plants, mostly fueled by natural gas.

Dozens of sprawling off-grid data center projects are planned across Texas, New Mexico, Pennsylvania, Wyoming, Utah, Ohio and Tennessee, according to a review of regulatory filings, permits, earnings call transcripts and other documents by the energy industry research firm Cleanview. Several are already under construction.

Companies rushing to develop the facilities include Meta, ChatGPT-maker OpenAI, business software provider Oracle and oil giant Chevron. (The Washington Post has a content partnership

SEE DATA CENTERS ON A8

THE WORLD

An orphaned monkey in Japan captures hearts — and fuels toy sales. **A12**

SPORTS

U.S. men's hockey has a shot at its first gold since the 1980 "Miracle." **B1**



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TRAVEL

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METRO

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